

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

This article appeared on a website:



Digital museums

Can't afford a trip to Paris to see the *Mona Lisa* at the Louvre? Good news! Technology is helping to make art available to everyone. By putting their collections online, museums are bypassing geographic barriers and preserving art and culture.

One institute already doing this is Google Arts & Culture. They work with more than 1000 museums around the world to digitise and display their art collections for all to enjoy.

Their open access online platform includes more than 6 million digitalised photos and videos of artworks, cultural artifacts and historical documents.

With just a few mouse clicks, viewers can experience art in new ways. They can tour partner museum collections and galleries to explore the artworks in detail with Google's high-resolution image technology. The platform includes advanced search capabilities and educational tools.

So, why not enjoy interactive games such as searching for hidden details in artwork or solving artistic puzzles with family or friends? Better yet, download Google's AR (augmented reality) app: you can play with the art filter and turn yourself into the *Mona Lisa*!



Your group is doing a project on digital museums. You are meeting to discuss the topic. You may want to talk about:

- why some museums want to put their art collections online
- how viewing art online is different from viewing it in person
- how local museums can compete with digital museums to attract visitors
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Do you enjoy going to museums?
2. Should there be more art lessons in schools?
3. Who visits museums more: young people or the elderly?
4. Do you think digital museums will become more popular?
5. Should students be encouraged to visit art museums?
6. Do you prefer looking at art or making your own art?
7. Should all museums be free to the public?
8. What can people learn by viewing art?